

SECTION 1

Foundations

The system stands on two type families and a small set of ink colors. Everything else — every heading, label, and caption — is built by varying the size, weight, and case of these two families against the ink palette. Resist adding a third family or new colors; reach for the existing tokens first.

SERIF — LONG-FORM, DISPLAY

Source Serif 4

Italic and optical sizes:

Aa Aa • Aa Aa Aa

Weights used: 300, 400, 500, 600

Use the serif for the cover title, all section & subsection headings, chart titles, the lead paragraph, footnote markers, and chart source lines. Always honor the optical-size axis: the cover title sits at opsz 60, section heads at opsz 36, body and captions at opsz 14–18.

SANS — UI, LABELS, BODY

Inter

Weights used: 400, 500, 600, 700

Aa Aa Aa Aa

Use Inter for body copy, all chart labels & ticks, annotations, table headers and cells, TOC sub-entries, page chrome (running head, folio, footnotes), eyebrows, figure labels, and any small uppercase label. Always pair tabular numerics (font-variant-numeric: tabular-nums) on numeric columns.

TYPE SCALE

56 px	Cover display	.display
34 px	Section heading	h1.section
20 px	Subsection heading	h2.subsection
17 px	Lead paragraph	p.lead
14 px	Colophon body / chart title	.colophon p / .chart-title
12 px	Body copy, chart text, table cells	p, axis, table
11 px	COVER META (SERIES / DATE)	cover only
10 px	FIGURE LABEL / CHART SOURCE	h3.figure-label / .chart-source
9 px	RUNNING HEAD / FOLIO / FOOTNOTES	.running-head, .folio, .footnotes

Ink & accent palette

Text is layered: black for emphasis (`--ink`), near-black for body (`--ink-2`), warm grey for secondary/captions (`--ink-3`), and a paler grey for hairlines & markers (`--ink-4`). The accent blue is reserved for eyebrows, figure labels, brand marks, and the cover date.

	<code>--ink</code>	#1A1714	Cover title, section & subsection heads, table emphasis, strong
	<code>--ink-2</code>	#2C2823	Body copy default, axis text, table cells
	<code>--ink-3</code>	#6B645A	Captions, eyebrow on cover, page chrome, sub-sub TOC
	<code>--ink-4</code>	#9A9389	Hairline rules, trendlines, secondary markers
	<code>--accent</code>	#015C9C	Cover date, eyebrows, figure labels, primary chart series
	<code>cover bg</code>	#F3F2EA	Cover page paper color only — do not use on content pages

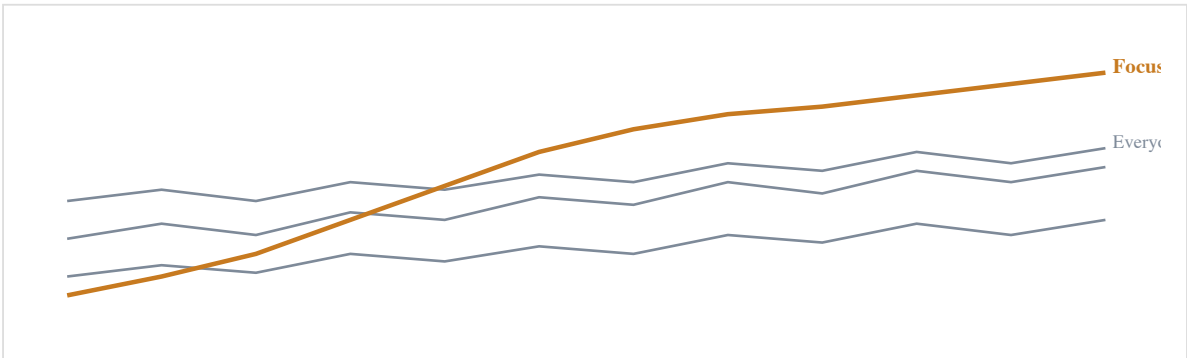
CHART PALETTE (CATEGORICAL)

	<code>c-1</code>	#015C9C	Primary — single-series default
	<code>c-2</code>	#C77A20	Contrast / lead-finding amber
	<code>c-3</code>	#CEC96B	Third series
	<code>c-4</code>	#51B196	Fourth series
	<code>c-5</code>	#A8352C	Fifth series
	<code>c-6</code>	#918BED	Sixth series

MUTED (DE-EMPHASIS ENCODING)

	<code>c-muted</code>	#7E8A99	Background data — paints the “everyone else” series when one is highlighted
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Use #7E8A99 to mute non-focus data points so a single highlighted series stands out. Typical pattern: paint every line / dot in `--c-muted`, then re-paint the focus series on top in `--c-2` (or another accent). The muted layer carries the general trend; the highlight carries the story.



RULES FOR USING COLOR

1. **Color encodes meaning, not decoration.** Every color in a chart must carry a specific function — a category, a series, a threshold, a highlight. If a color is not earning its keep, remove it.
2. **Keep most charts to two to four colors.** A reader can hold only a few categories in working memory at once. When a chart truly needs more series, encode the rest with the muted color and let the focus series carry the story.
3. **Use color to highlight; mute the rest.** Paint the focus series in an accent (typically --c-1 or --c-2) and the supporting data in --c-muted (#7E8A99). The muted layer carries the trend; the highlight carries the finding.

SECTION 2

Display & cover type

DISPLAY

New Mexico's Economy Over Time and Space

Use once per document — the cover title only. Always pair with a 2-px black rule below and the author byline. Never wrap to more than three lines.

CLASS	.display
FAMILY	Source Serif 4
SIZE	56 px
WEIGHT	400
LEADING	0.96
TRACKING	-0.025em
OPSZ	60
COLOR	--ink

COVER META — SERIES

GROWTH LAB WORKING PAPER SERIES

Sits in the top-left corner of the cover, above the date.

FAMILY	Inter
SIZE	11 px
WEIGHT	600
CASE	Uppercase, 0.18em tracking
COLOR	#6B645A (--ink-3)

COVER META — DATE

MAY 2026

Always immediately below the series line, in accent blue at weight 700.

FAMILY	Inter
SIZE	11 px
WEIGHT	700
CASE	Uppercase, 0.18em tracking
COLOR	--accent (#015C9C)

COVER AUTHORS

Juan Carlos Orrego Zamudio and Tim O'Brien

A single line below the title rule. Comma-separated; use "and" before the last author.

FAMILY	Source Serif 4
SIZE	14 px
WEIGHT	400
LEADING	1.5
COLOR	#6B645A

SECTION 3

Section headings

SECTION TITLE

A boom built on two minerals

First element inside `.page-inner`. Spans the full content row (`grid-column: 1 / -1`). Always sentence case — never trailing period. Avoid manual `<br>`.

CLASS	h1.section
FAMILY	Source Serif 4
SIZE	34 px
WEIGHT	500
LEADING	1.08
TRACKING	-0.018em
OPSZ	36
COLOR	--ink

SUBSECTION

The Herfindahl-Hirschman story

Within a section, marks a thematic break. Sentence case, no trailing period. Top margin 28 px from preceding paragraph; use `style="margin-top: 0"` when first in a page.

CLASS	h2.subsection
FAMILY	Source Serif 4
SIZE	20 px
WEIGHT	500
LEADING	1.2
TRACKING	-0.01em
OPSZ	22
COLOR	--ink

SECTION 4

Body copy

BODY PARAGRAPH

Two things explain almost everything about Mongolia's economy since 2003: the price of copper, and the appetite of Chinese steel-makers for coking coal. When both rose, Mongolia ran one of the fastest growth rates on Earth. When either stalled, so did the country.

Default paragraph for all narrative text inside .page-inner (except the colophon and the cover). One blank line between paragraphs.

SELECTOR	p
FAMILY	Inter
SIZE	12 px
WEIGHT	400
LEADING	1.6
COLOR	--ink-2
EMPHASIS	 → 600, --ink

COLOPHON BODY (PAGE 2)

This research was conducted by the Growth Lab through a grant from Resilient Energy Economies. It was done in partnership with New Mexico's Economic Development Department.

Used only on the colophon (imprint / page 2). Serif, slightly bigger and more open than the default sans body.

CLASS	.colophon p
FAMILY	Source Serif 4
SIZE	14 px
WEIGHT	400
LEADING	1.55
OPSZ	14
COLOR	--ink-2

FOOTNOTE

¹Source: Growth Lab analysis. See methodology appendix for definitions and data sources.

Anchor in serif italic accent. Note text in 9-px sans, ink-3. Rendered at the bottom of the page next to the folio.

CLASS	.folio-note
FAMILY	Inter
SIZE	9 px
LEADING	1.5
COLOR	--ink-3

SECTION 5

Lead paragraph

LEAD PARAGRAPH

Mongolia rode the 2003–2013 commodity supercycle into the upper-middle income bracket. The boom built schools, paved Ulaanbaatar, and lifted eight hundred thousand people out of poverty.

Lifts the opening paragraph of a section, the executive summary, or any standout intro. One per section, immediately under the heading.

CLASS	p. lead
FAMILY	Source Serif 4
SIZE	17 px
WEIGHT	300
LEADING	1.4
OPSZ	18
COLOR	--ink-2

Chart typography

FIGURE LABEL
FIGURE 4

Top of every figure block. Accent blue, uppercase.
Always numbered sequentially.

CLASS	h3.figure-label
FAMILY	Inter
SIZE	10 px
WEIGHT	600
CASE	Uppercase, 0.14em
COLOR	--accent

CHART TITLE
Six-series line chart, solid strokes.

Headline of a chart. Always ends in a period because
it's a finding-statement, not a label.

CLASS	.chart-title
FAMILY	Source Serif 4
SIZE	14 px
WEIGHT	500
LEADING	1.25
TRACKING	-0.005em
COLOR	--ink

CHART SUBTITLE
Share of merchandise exports by category, 2003–2024,
percent.

Optional. Gives the chart units, the period covered, and
the unit of analysis. Omit when redundant with the
title.

CLASS	.chart-subtitle
FAMILY	Inter
SIZE	12 px
WEIGHT	400
LEADING	1.4
COLOR	--ink-3

AXIS LABEL & TICK
% real GDP growth
0 25 50 75 100

Axis labels sit above (Y) or below (X) the plot area.
Use tabular-nums for ticks so numbers align.

SELECTOR	.axis-label, .axis-tick
FAMILY	Inter
SIZE	12 px
WEIGHT	Label 500 / tick 400
COLOR	--ink-2

Chart typography

SERIES LABEL

Series 1 Series 2

Two options: direct labels at the end of each line, or a small legend below the chart. Color matches the series stroke. Avoid both at once.

CLASS	.series-label
FAMILY	Inter
SIZE	12 px
WEIGHT	600
COLOR	matches series

IN-CHART ANNOTATION

2018 commodity reflation

Use sparingly — only to call out a single, story-driving data point. Pair with a hairline marker. Sans (no italic).

CLASS	.annotation
FAMILY	Inter
SIZE	12 px
COLOR	--ink-2

CHART SOURCE

Source: Growth Lab analysis of UN Comtrade. Categories: Coal (HS 2701, 2702); Copper (HS 2603, 7402).

Always required. One line below the chart. Italic serif distinguishes provenance from the data narrative.

CLASS	.chart-source
FAMILY	Source Serif 4 italic
SIZE	10 px
LEADING	1.45
COLOR	--ink-2

Table typography

TABLE SAMPLE

Sector	2024 exports (USD m)	Strategic value
Processed meat & dairy	142	0.84
Cashmere garments	218	0.79

Sentence-case headers (never all caps). Text columns left-aligned; numeric columns right-aligned with *tabular-nums*. Top & bottom rules in ink; row dividers in *--rule*.

CLASS	.report-table
FAMILY	Inter (both head and body)
SIZE	12 px throughout
WEIGHT	Header 600 / body 400
LEADING	1.45
COLOR	Head <i>--ink</i> ; body <i>--ink-2</i>
STRONG	First column emphasis <i>--ink 600</i>

SECTION 8

Table of contents styles

TOC MAJOR ENTRY

Long-term perspective (1900–2020)	4
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Top-level section in the TOC. Serif 14 px, semibold ink, sentence case (no all caps). Top border in ink.

CLASS	.toc-row.major
FAMILY	Source Serif 4
SIZE	14 px
WEIGHT	600
COLOR	--ink

TOC SUB-ENTRY

Overview of 120 years of population growth	4
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Nested under a major entry. Sans 12 px, ink-2, 18-px indent.

CLASS	.toc-row.sub
FAMILY	Inter
SIZE	12 px
WEIGHT	400
COLOR	--ink-2

TOC SUB-SUB ENTRY

Perspective on urban areas	32
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For two-level deep nesting. Italic, ink-3, deeper indent.

CLASS	.toc-row.sub-sub
FAMILY	Inter italic
SIZE	12 px
COLOR	--ink-3

Page chrome

RUNNING HEAD

GROWTH LAB WORKING PAPER NO. 264

[GL]

Sits at the top of every content page (omitted on cover). Series tag on the left, 25-px Growth Lab logo on the right.

CLASS	.running-head
FAMILY	Inter
SIZE	9 px
WEIGHT	500
CASE	Uppercase, 0.16em tracking
COLOR	--ink-3

FOLIO & FOLIO-NOTE

¹ Source: Growth Lab analysis. See methodology appendix.

Bottom of every content page (omitted on cover, TOC, colophon, references). Page number flush right; optional footnote on the left.

CLASS	.folio / .folio-note
FAMILY	Number: Inter / Note: Source Serif 4 italic
SIZE	Number 9 px / note 10 px
COLOR	--ink-3

SECTION 10

Decision rules

The system is small on purpose. Before introducing a new style, work through this list.

1. **Serif or sans?** Serif for the cover, all headings, the lead, the colophon, chart titles, and chart sources. Sans for everything else.
2. **Body size is 12 px.** Do not push body text below 12 px. Footnotes (9 px) are the only exception, and they live next to the folio.
3. **No trailing periods on headings.** Section headings, subsection headings, and TOC entries end without a period. Chart titles end with a period (they read as a finding).
4. **No all-caps body or headings.** Uppercase is reserved for eyebrows, figure labels, running heads, and similar 9–11 px chrome.
5. **Color is for emphasis, not decoration.** Default ink layers: `--ink` (titles, strong), `--ink-2` (body), `--ink-3` (captions, chrome), `--ink-4` (hairlines). Reach for `--accent` only for eyebrows, figure labels, the cover date, and the primary chart series.
6. **Tabular numerals in tables and charts.** Always set `font-variant-numeric: tabular-nums` on numeric cells, axis ticks, page numbers, and TOC page numbers.
7. **One lead per section.** A p. lead never appears twice on the same page.
8. **Cover meta is two lines.** Series name in ink-3 weight 600; date in accent weight 700. Never combine them on one line.
9. **Subtitle is optional, source is required.** Every chart needs a `.chart-source`. The `.chart-subtitle` can be omitted when redundant.
10. **No monospace.** Numerals use Inter with tabular figures. Avoid mono fonts in body, charts, and tables.